

Google Currents updated

Google recently updated its news-reading app Google Currents by adding new features. The app is a direct competitor of Flipboard

Tasered for buying many iPhones

In another one of those iDevice related news, a Chinese woman got tasered after wanting to purchase too many iPhones at a mall in New Hampshire, England

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but considering most users looking at an H77 rig will not be indulging in overclocking, the stock cooler will fit just fine. You may have to insert the memory sticks after installing the cooler though.

All the boards lack a heat-sink over the VRM indicating its lower power profile but the chipsets have a passive heat-sink. Thanks to the absence of a heatsink around the VRM circuitry, there is ample room around the CPU socket. We did not like the placement of all the headers and fan connec-

tors along the PCIe slot on the Intel DH77DF. The Gigabyte board was the best in terms of layout, with ASUS being the second best. ASUS does manage to pack in six SATA ports (2xSATA 3 and 4xSATA 2) which is impressive. As expected, all SATA ports are pointing upwards. The presence of a Wi-Fi adapter on the Gigabyte H77N board differentiates it from the other two boards. The Intel board does have a mini-PCIe slot to add in a Wi-Fi card though. Coming to the backpanel IO, all three

boards provided quite a variety. The Gigabyte board sports two LAN ports, a Wi-Fi antenna, two USB 3.0 ports along with three display outs (2xHDMI, 1xDVI). Intel shows some variety in terms of an eSATA port, a FireWire port and three display outs (DVI, HDMI, DisplayPort). Finally, ASUS has the standard set of ports including two USB 3.0, six USB 2.0 and three display outs (DVI, D-Sub and DisplayPort). The graphical BIOSes on the Gigabyte and the ASUS boards is quite impressive as compared to the regular BIOS on the Intel DH77DF.

x16 slot and instead have a PCIe x1 slot. The ASUS and Foxconn board each have a PCIe x16 slot (Gen 2). Clearance around the CPU region in the Intel, MSI and Foxconn board is much better than that on the ASUS board. But this again will matter only if you are using a large CPU cooler, which is pointless

on such a board as you will not be doing any overclocking. None of the boards have any heatsinks around the VRM circuitry. Heat-sinks on the chipset are present on all boards with the Foxconn and ASUS ones being slightly better off than the rest. The Foxconn board has just two SATA 2 ports, whereas MSI and ASUS boards have twice that. All the ports point upward, but their alignment is different on all the boards. While ASUS sticks to the more standard way of arranging them in a line, MSI has them arranged one beside the other in a horizontal manner which may seem strange, but it does give room for the SATA cables. Also it can afford to do that as it has a PCIe x1 slot.

Coming to the backpanel ports, there isn't much happening really as compared to the Z77 and H77 boards. The Intel board sports a parallel port, making it an ideal board to be used for office work, but it is good to see two USB 3.0 ports, a D-Sub and a DVI port as well. The USB 3.0 port on the Intel board is thanks to the Renesas NEC chip. ASUS is the only other H61 board that sports two USB 3.0 ports thanks to the Asmedia controller chip. Since the DH61DL board does not support the Intel Core i7-3770K, we had called in for an Core i5-3540S. Despite updating the BIOS, we were facing a lot of issues so we had to use a second

The H61 boards

The H61 boards are the lower end of the Intel chipset spectrum. The H61 chipset is ideally meant for lower-budget builds and meant for those who will use it for an HTPC build or office work. With the lack of native USB 3.0 support and no support for SATA 3 speeds, this board has its limits. There are board manufacturers who add a separate chip to allow USB 3.0 ports on the backpanel IO, but that's about it. It also lacks RAID support and SSD caching. We got around four boards in this segment namely: Intel DH61DL, MSI H61I-E35, ASUS P8H61-I and Foxconn H61S. Of these four boards, you can forget gaming on the MSI H61I-E35 and Intel DH61DL as they lack a dedicated PCIe



ASUS P8Z77-I Deluxe